



Kindergarten Learning Progression Executive function

Validated version

Australian Council for Educational Research
Prepared for Queensland Department of Education
January 2023

Kindergarten Learning Progression

Executive function

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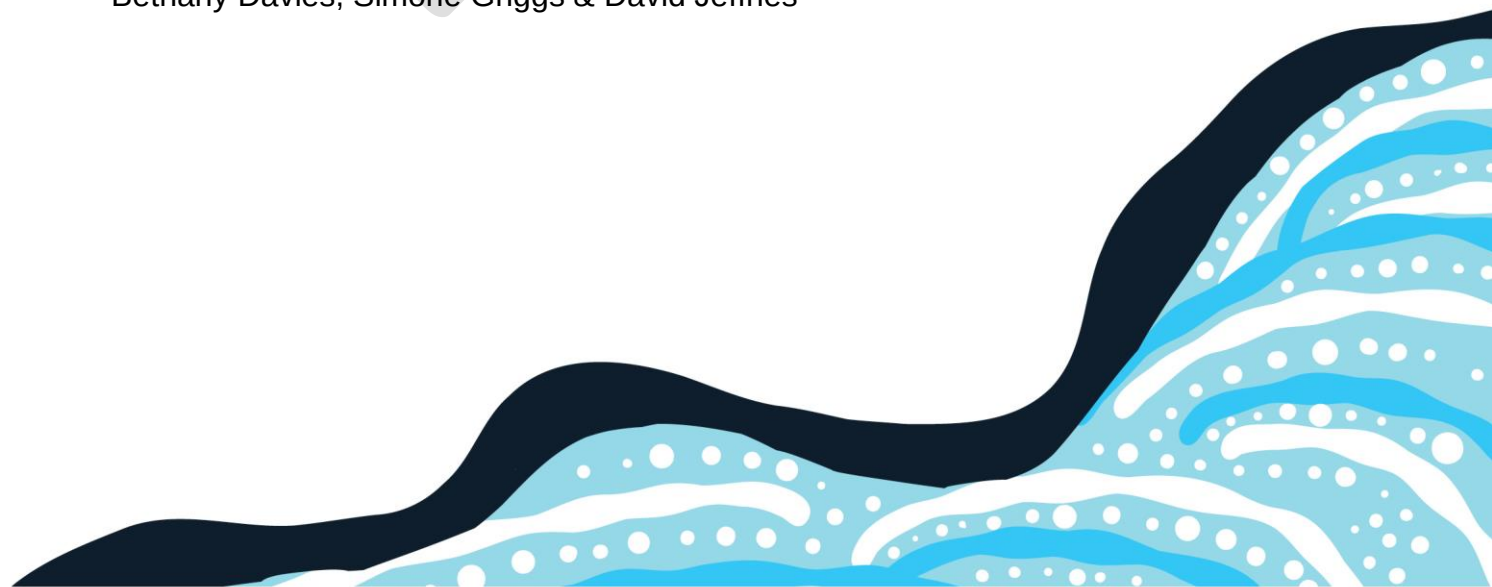
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Observable changes in children’s learning and development

Links to QKLG: Identity, wellbeing, active learning

Persistence	- Observes tasks being performed by others, preparing to undertake one element of the task. - Completes a single element of a highly structured tasks (e.g., finds their bag when they need to put their bag on their back). - Demonstrates joint attention (e.g., in a group situation, can direct their attention on the same object when prompted). - Requires assistance from others to stay engaged, (e.g., provision of simple, manageable tasks). - Relies on routines, schedules and prompts to engage with activities and tasks effectively.	- Completes simple, routine tasks with one step instructions (e.g., putting their bag in their locker). - Maintains focus despite minor distractions (e.g., staying on task, ignoring the sounds of peers playing nearby). - Persists through small setbacks or challenges (e.g., when equipment is missing). - Waits for their turn in a game with one other person or when asked to line-up for a short period. - Requires reassurance with tasks that are new or challenging. - Engages best when verbal and visual prompts are provided for a task. - Requires instructions to be repeated. - May not identify when they need help.	- Persists with tasks involving multiple steps that require some time, effort, and patience (e.g., building a block tower). - Maintains focused attention when engaged in preferred tasks. - Persists after an initial set-back but may require support if challenges continue (e.g., trying to put shoes on) - Waits for their turn in a game involving two or three people (e.g., they are last in a line of children waiting and they do not express frustration verbally or physically). - May show hesitance with new or challenging tasks. - Aware of needing help but may not always ask for it.	- Persists with tasks involving more than three steps which require time, effort and patience (e.g., solving a multipiece puzzle, playing a game with several players). - Resists distractions when focused on a new task (e.g., background noise, peers playing close-by, and lunch is being served). - Attempts to manage set-backs and persist independently. May ask a peer or adult for help. - Waits patiently for their turn when a game or task demands it (e.g., in a game of UNO if it is their turn next, but then order is reversed, so they now have to wait longer to have their turn). - Seeks reassurance and responds appropriately to the feedback.	- Manages multiple different setbacks and distractions throughout complex tasks (tailored to the child’s ability). - Supports others by providing strategies for managing setbacks. - Actively congratulates others, recognizing their persistence, and helps or encourages them. - Demonstrates patience and consideration when waiting for others to take their turn. - Completes multi-step, goal-oriented tasks independently and successfully.
Adaptability	- Engages in routine tasks using familiar methods and strategies. - Engages with new tasks or activities. May take time to feel confident with new tasks or activities.	- Adapts when small changes are made to daily routines (e.g., a change to the order of activities). - Adapts to a small change made midway through an activity or game, (e.g., when a peer suggests a different way to build the tower). - Explores unfamiliar learning environments or materials. - Participates in simple activities where thinking is required, and extensive practice and supportive clues are provided. - Participates in tasks where trial and error are involved, with opportunities to experiment and try out a hypothesis.	- Adapts to major changes to daily routines (however, may still become slightly over-excited, or anxious). - Adapts to a more complex change made mid-way through an activity or game (e.g., the game has changed from building an aeroplane with blocks to building a car). - Explores unfamiliar learning environments or materials (may tend to focus on a few elements only or areas more in line with their interests). - Participates in tasks where they can engage in trial and error, where solutions are not obvious, to experiment and try out a hypothesis with some guidance.	- Adapts to major changes in daily routines without requiring support. - Flexibly adapts to multiple changes throughout an activity or game. - Thoroughly explores new contexts or materials, seeking opportunities to explore new environments and resources to extend their learning. - Participates in tasks where they can engage in using higher order thinking skills, confidently experimenting and formulating their own hypothesis needing minimal guidance.	Demonstrates flexibility in response to their peers’ needs (e.g., invents rules to make the game easier or harder for different players).

Problem solving	- Engages with simple problem-solving strategies with some adult support (e.g., finding a card, looking at a picture). - Focuses on the sensory aspects of a problem or task, rather than applying problem-solving strategies to identify the actual problem (e.g., notices that their clothes feel cold when wet but does not identify the need to change out of wet clothes). - May not independently identify simple, routine problems without adult guidance.	- Demonstrates predictable or familiar strategies for how a routine problem might be solved (e.g., what do we do if our drink bottle is empty?). - Attempts to experiment with new and unfamiliar materials, (e.g., incorporating unexpected elements into a process). - Shares how they attempted to solve a problem (may not reflect what actually happened). - Makes a simple plan (e.g., a role play of a familiar fairytale) that involves some collaboration or sequencing but is largely spontaneous. - Engages with aspects of an activity for sensory exploration or enjoyment, without necessarily seeking a solution (e.g., builds a block tower, enjoying the sound of it falling down and not viewing the ‘falling tower’ as a problem).	- Communicates 1-2 ideas for how a problem with unfamiliar materials might be solved (e.g., construction of a three-dimensional object using recycled materials). - Experiments with at least two different, familiar ways to solve a problem. (e.g., how to negotiate a play space with peers, but requires some hints and ideas to try more imaginative and potentially effective approaches from a teacher or educator). - Describes, with prompting, some aspects of how they attempted to solve a problem. When prompted they can communicate what worked or did not work, reflecting on what they did. - Independently plans and sequences an activity that happens within one day (e.g., putting on a simple play including assigning roles, simple costumes, and a basic plot) as well as adjusting to minor disruptions (e.g., a conflict between two children wanting the same costume). - Evaluates their own responses and may change their solution in response to feedback.	- Communicates several ideas for how an unfamiliar problem might be solved (e.g., how to dismantle a piece of unfamiliar equipment with spanners and screwdrivers). - Experiments with diverse and imaginative ways to solve an unfamiliar problem (e.g., incorporating new and unfamiliar resources into an activity). - Describes, without prompting, how they attempted to solve a problem providing some reasons for what they did, or did not do, why it worked or did not work and what they might do differently next time. - Independently or collaboratively plan and sequence an activity with peers that involves a series of steps to take place over two or more days (e.g., putting on an elaborate play with a detailed plot and consideration of how to engage the audience), including adjusting to disruptions and unanticipated events (e.g., rain during an outdoor scene in the play).	- Leads others through solutions to problems. - Provides a range of solutions for different purposes. - Provides solutions that challenge rules or understood ways of doing things. - Rewrites rules to games to increase their challenge.
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